

Inventor of practical LED

Nick Holonyack Jr. developed the first practical visible-spectrum LED (red) in 1962 when working with GE

LED used to transfer data

Fraunhofer Institute for Telecommunications researchers have used commercial LEDs to transmit data wirelessly at 230 Mbps

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Power cuts and water shortages have become grim realities of our lives.

It's a clear case of a skewed demand - supply ratio. Everyone has, at some point or the other, faced power and water shortages. Conventional sources of energy are fast depleting. With a booming population, short supply of resources is inevitable. Thus, the need for investing in alternative sources of energy is paramount.

We come across lots of articles and web sites telling us what steps to take to cut down on your power consumption, how to make your life more green and the likes. We at Digit, believe in doing all those things. So for this issue, we decided to hunt for individuals who have actually gone ahead and done something in this regard.

The people you will read about in the following paragraphs are people like us, who lead normal lives and have normal power consumption needs. But their attitude towards sustainable living is what sets them apart from us. These are people who have taken pro-active rather than

reactive measures to future proof their energy needs.

Lighting up your house

Three thousand kilometers of cycling a year is just one of the things that the determined Atul Gopal indulges in. His other pet project is saving energy by switching to alternative means to light up his house. An engineer and MBA by education, Gopal is the founding member of a training institute in Pune which prepares students for management entrance exams. Since the last two years, Gopal has adopted light emitting diodes to light up his drawing room.

So what really prompted him to switch to LED lights inspite of knowing that it was going to be an expensive affair. "In 2008 my friends Pankaj and Rahul, engineers from IIT Bombay, were working on street lighting using LED lamps. I pestered them into doing something for my drawing room," he said. The pestering worked and the three friends got together to light up Gopal's drawing room.

The early days of adoption gave them a taste of failure as well. "In 2008 the LEDs available had a rating of 1 W, with a light



Greenvest for the future

Digit profiles citizens who are using alternative sources of energy to cut down on their electricity bills, in the process leading more greener and cleaner lives